Life went on, too. On August 4, after a couple of days of relative coolness, I managed to start the new robot story, "The Evitable Conflict," in which I pictured a world run by intelligent computers cooperating subtly enough to leave humanity with the illusion that it was still in charge.

On August 15, I got a new kind of acceptance: The Journal of the American Chemical Society was going to run my paper.

On the nineteenth we took the bus to Jaffrey, and our first impression of Birchtoft was as woeful as our first impression of Hilltop Lodge had been back in 1943. Our temporary quarters were horrible, and the

food was poor and rather flatly American. There was bacon at breakfast and none of the Jewish delicacies we had had at Chester's Zunbarg— which we missed unbearably the first few days. What's more, the lake was ten minutes distant through the woods.

On the first day, however, one of the guests, seeing that we were clearly unhappy, spoke consolingly and assured us the place would grow on us—and indeed the place did seem to improve with time. We got better quarters, the food wasn't so bad after all, and the walk through the woods to the lake was actually pleasant.

The master of ceremonies was Leonard Cibley, who was a student at the Medical School (the world is always a surprisingly small one), and he was excellent at dialect jokes. I envied him exceedingly. I tell jokes very well myself, but can only handle the Yiddish dialect.

The weather was variable. The first few days were actually cold, and a fire had to be built in the sitting room. Considering that it was one of Boston's hottest summers, it seemed ironic that, after our superheated Somerville attic, we were to be sitting there shivering but there was a welcome novelty to it also. There were other days, however, when the temperatures went into the nineties.

We met Morris and Lillian Cohen, who were a particularly pleasant couple; he short and bald, she short and blond, both highly articulate. They were celebrating their sixteenth wedding anniversary. We grew friendly with them when I noticed Maury (as we eventually came to call him) carrying a copy of the current Astounding.

He didn't know who I was, since it was customary at resorts to use first names only, as another way of shutting out the real world, and I felt it safe and